Experiment No: 2

Comparative Study of Low-Code Development Platforms

Aim

To study and compare various low-code development platforms available in the market, with special reference to Zoho Creator, and to analyze their features, advantages, limitations and suitability for different application development needs.

Software / Tools Required

- A computer/laptop with internet connection
- Web browser (Google Chrome / Microsoft Edge)
- Zoho Creator account (free trial / sign up at creator.zoho.com)
- Web browser access to other low-code platforms for comparison (e.g., OutSystems, Mendix, Microsoft Power Apps, Appian) — trial/demo pages

Theory

Low-code development platforms (LCDPs) allow developers and even non-technical users (citizen developers) to build software applications quickly using visual, drag-and-drop interfaces instead of writing extensive lines of traditional code. These platforms provide pre-built templates, reusable components, visual workflow builders and built-in database management, which drastically reduce development time and effort.

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code application development platform that enables users to build custom business applications with drag-and-drop form builders, workflow automation, built-in database, and Deluge scripting language for advanced customization. It is widely used for building CRM tools, inventory management systems, HR applications and other business process automation solutions.

Other popular low-code platforms include Microsoft Power Apps, OutSystems, Mendix, and Appian, each differing in pricing, scalability, ease of use, and target audience (citizen developers vs professional developers).

Comparative Study Table

Feature / Platform	Zoho Creator	Microsoft Power Apps	OutSystems	Mendix
Ease of Use	Very easy, drag & drop builder	Easy, integrated with MS ecosystem	Moderate, needs some training	Moderate to advanced
Target Users	Citizen developers & small businesses	Business users in MS 365 environment	Professional developers	Professional & citizen developers
Scripting Language	Deluge Script	Power Fx	OutSystems language (visual)	Java / JavaScript (via extensions)
Deployment	Cloud (Zoho's servers)	Cloud (Azure)	Cloud / On-premise	Cloud / On-premise
Pricing	Affordable, free trial available	Subscription based (MS 365)	Expensive, enterprise focus	Free tier + paid plans
Integration	Zoho suite + third-party apps	Strong with Microsoft products	Wide enterprise integrations	Wide integration support

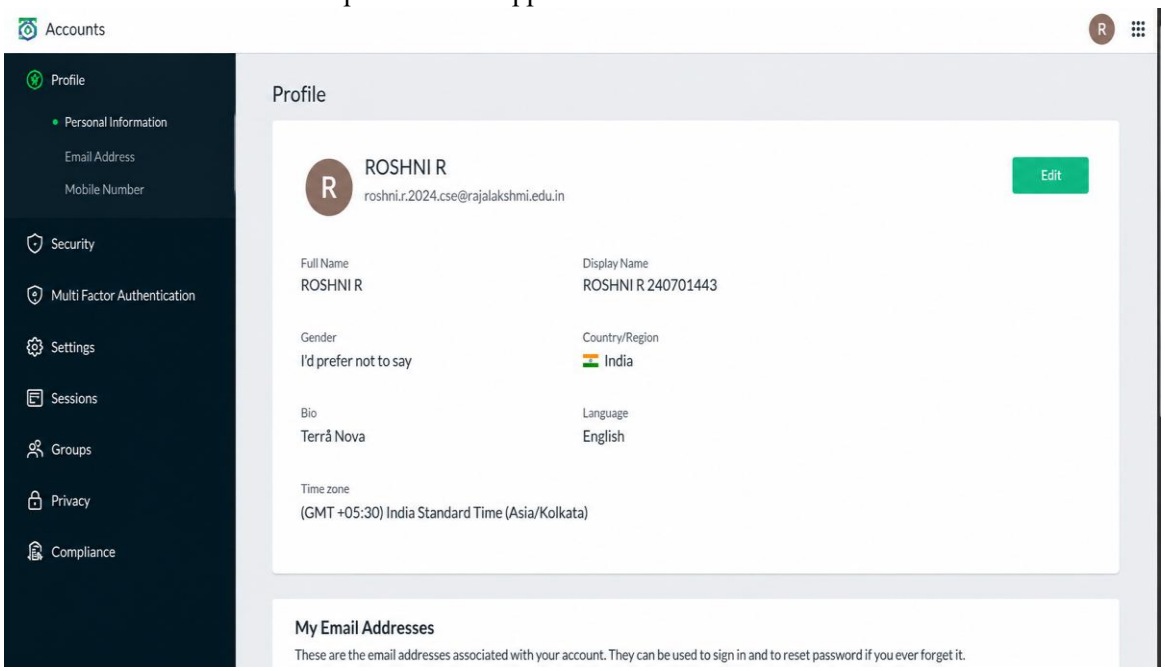
Best Suited For	SMBs, quick business apps	Organizations using Microsoft stack	Large-scale enterprise apps	Complex enterprise applications

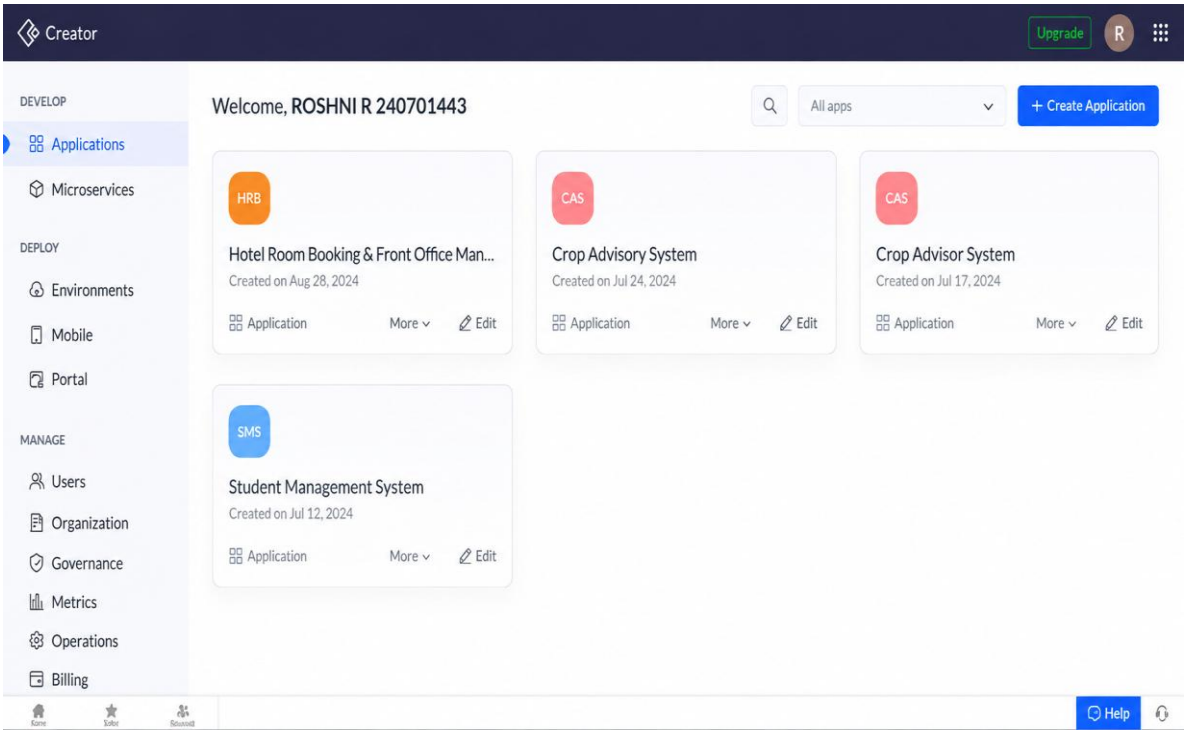
Procedure

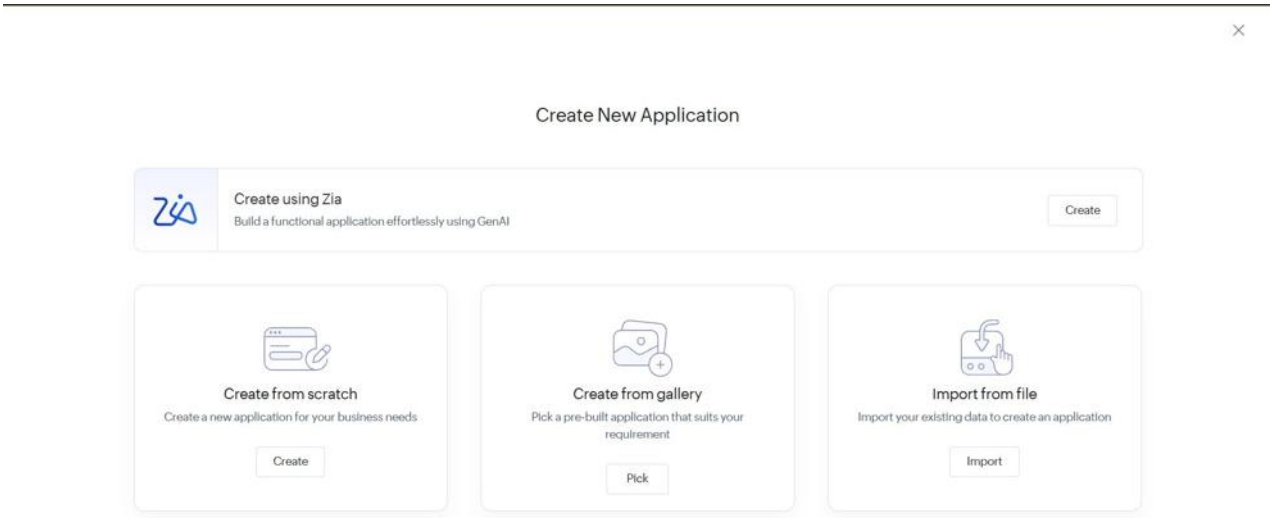
1. Open a web browser and go to the Zoho Creator website (creator.zoho.com).
2. Sign up for a new account or log in using an existing Zoho account.
3. Explore the Zoho Creator dashboard and note down the available features (Form builder, Workflow builder, Deluge scripting, Reports, Pages, etc.).
4. Create a new blank application in Zoho Creator to explore the drag-and-drop form builder interface.
5. Visit the official websites / demo pages of other low-code platforms such as Microsoft Power Apps, OutSystems, and Mendix.
6. Study and note the key features, pricing model, target audience, and ease of use of each platform.
7. Tabulate the observations of all the platforms based on common comparison parameters (ease of use, scripting language, deployment, pricing, integration, best use case).
8. Analyze the comparison table and summarize which platform is best suited for which type of application/organization.
9. Record the results and conclusions based on the comparative study.

Screenshots

Add screenshots for each of the steps below to support the observations recorded above.




Creator
Upgrade
R
DEVELOP
Applications
Microservices
DEPLOY
Environments
Mobile
Portal
MANAGE
Users
Organization
Governance
Metrics
Operations
Billing
Welcome, ROSHNI R 240701443
All apps
+ Create Application
HRB
Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Man...
Created on Aug 28, 2024
Application
More
Edit
CAS
Crop Advisory System
Created on Jul 24, 2024
Application
More
Edit
CAS
Crop Advisor System
Created on Jul 17, 2024
Application
More
Edit
SMS
Student Management System
Created on Jul 12, 2024
Application
More
Edit
Help


Create New Application
Create using Zia
Build a functional application effortlessly using GenAI
Create
Create from scratch
Create a new application for your business needs
Create
Create from gallery
Pick a pre-built application that suits your requirement
Pick
Import from file
Import your existing data to create an application
Import

Result

The comparative study of various low-code development platforms was successfully carried out. It was observed that Zoho Creator is best suited for small and medium businesses that need quick, affordable application development with minimal coding effort, whereas platforms like OutSystems and Mendix are more suitable for large-scale enterprise applications requiring high scalability, and Microsoft Power Apps is ideal for organizations already using the Microsoft ecosystem.